ARTUR CEMPURA

ENGINEERING MANAGER / SOFTWARE ENGINEERING TEAM LEAD

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SUMMARY

Product-facing Engineering Manager / Software Engineering Team Lead with 8+ years in software orgs (6+ in leadership) delivering customer-facing sportsbook experiences. Scaled teams (2 to 9) and shipped measurable reliability + conversion impact: 99.9% uptime at ~800k tx/day, Lighthouse +20%, bet placement +8%, and 90% faster bet discovery. Lead cross-functional squads (Product/Design/QA/Analytics/DS/ML) through roadmap delivery, legacy modernisation, and operational excellence. Hands-on technical leadership across AWS, event-driven systems, CI/CD, observability, and security automation; experienced with distributed collaboration (PL/UK).

CORE SKILLS

- **People leadership:** hiring, coaching, growth plans, performance management (incl. PIP), team health
- **Delivery & execution:** roadmap planning, Agile/Scrum, OKRs, cross-team coordination, risk and dependency management
- **Stakeholder management:** Product partnership, executive comms, conflict resolution, distributed collaboration (PL/UK)
- **Technical leadership:** distributed systems, API design, event-driven systems, legacy modernisation
- **Reliability & ops:** SLO focus, incident management, MTTR, release discipline
- **DevEx / SDLC:** CI/CD, automation, observability practices, security-by-default workflows
- **Tech:** TypeScript/JavaScript, React, WebSockets, AWS (DynamoDB, MSK/Kafka), REST APIs, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions / GitLab CI

EXPERIENCE

Evoke plc (William Hill / 888), Kraków (Krakow), Poland

Software Engineering Team Lead | Dec 2021 – Present

Scope: grew team from 2 → 9 engineers (6 direct reports + 3 dotted-line for 6 months); dedicated Product Owner; hiring and performance ownership.

- Scaled and led a full-stack product team (peak 9 engineers), hiring 4 engineers, coaching, and ran performance cycles (1 raise, PIP → redundancy) to maintain a high bar and team health.
- Built and operated the two data layers (REST API, DynamoDB, MSK/Kafka), standardising data processing across 22 sports for .com/.es; ~800k transactions/day, 99.9% uptime, ~2h MTTR, and +6 months with zero P1s after release.
- Led replacement of a legacy server-side rendered JavaScript templating app with a React/TypeScript client app (Diffusion/WebSockets), enabling 22 sports in 3 months, improving Lighthouse Performance Score (LPS) +20%, and increasing bet placement +8%.
- Coordinated a multi-repo release across 11 repositories for new Sportsbook tech stack visual identity updates, maintaining clear cross-team comms and predictable delivery.
- Implemented automated application and container security scanning across 9 repositories (Checkmarx code & container scanning), refactoring pipelines to reduce manual work and improve consistency.
- Introduced sprint planning framework aligned to business priorities; delivered 10 consecutive sprints, hitting the Sprint Goal and automated sprint review reporting (Confluence/JQL dashboards) to reduce prep time from ~2 hours to ~10 minutes per sprint.
- Developed senior engineers via structured growth plans; coached a Senior Engineer into Software Engineering Team Lead (now leading 6 engineers) via fortnightly 1:1s, OKRs, and delegated tech-lead ownership across 3 projects.

William Hill, Kraków (Krakow), Poland

Tech Product Owner | Dec 2020 – Dec 2021
Scope: led 1 squad (8 engineers, 2 designers, 2 QA, analytics, DS/ML contractor team).

- Delivered v1 live football bet discovery behind a feature flag (FE components, APIs, and v1 recommendation engine), reducing time to find a relevant bet by 90% and reducing bet placement journey to two clicks (~50% fewer steps).

- Managed acquisition-driven reprioritisation 2 weeks pre-release: led comms and retrospective, and captured learnings from prototyping and user testing.
- Shipped a new search application for UK Sportsbook, increasing CTR +37%, adding gaming cross-sell, and reducing support queries by 20%.
- Delivered a loyalty product, increasing a target wallet type among existing customers by 18% and growing a specific bet market share by 10%.

Operations Manager in Engineering (CTO org) | Sep 2019 – Dec 2020

- Led CTO-wide OKR adoption across 4 departments (Sportsbook, Gaming, Core, Retail), reaching 84% team participation with quarterly cadence and executive reporting (town halls).
- Delivered Algolia search onboarding for Sportsbook (.com) from POC to production in 3 months, improving search latency by 24% and reducing zero-results rate to ~0%; enabled rapid iteration on facets/ranking rules.
- Coordinated acquisition integration set-up across ~8 teams over ~6 months, establishing ways of working and onboarding streams to de-risk a large platform migration programme.

Earlier Experience

- *IT Manager | Grand Parade, Krakow, Poland | Apr 2018 – Sep 2019*
- *IT Asset Management Specialist | Apr 2016 – Apr 2018*
    - Delivered a **6,200 m²** office infrastructure project within budget and a **3-month** timeline; established hardware/software processes.

EDUCATION

- **IT Technician** — IT Technical College in Bochnia (2010 – 2014)

CERTIFICATIONS

- AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (2025)
- Professional Scrum Product Owner (PSPO I) — Scrum.org (2022)
- Professional Scrum Master (PSM I) — Scrum.org (2022)
- Change Management Foundation — APMG International (2021)